

Guitarmalade C.O.R.E. (Complete, Organized, Real-world, Expertise) Curriculum

Review Option 1

Level 1

Find Notes Up 12 Down 5
Major Scale Along 1 string, in-position (1 Octave)
Major Pentatonic (1 Octave)
Root position triad, or Open Chord or Barre Chord

Play Song, ask: what is the Key, what is the tempo, meter, chord progression, are the chords diatonic? What is the arrangement? What is your favorite part of the song, what imagery does it solicit? If this song were in a movie trailer or movie scene what would the scene be?

Level 2

Find Notes Up 12 Down 5 (asc/desc)
Major Scale along 1 string, (in-position 2 octaves)
Major pentatonic (2 octaves)
major triad inversions across string-sets, or open chord or barre
find relative minor, play along 1 string

Play Song, ask: what is the Key, what is the tempo, meter, chord progression, are the chords diatonic? What is the arrangement? What is your favorite part of the song, what imagery does it solicit? If this song were in a movie trailer or movie scene what would the scene be?
Transpose progression to new key, apply open, barre or diad voicing

Level 3

find notes up 12 down 5, and octave shapes (asc/dsc)
major scale along 1 string, in-position and 3nps, string shift 1 octave
major pent 2 octaves and each pattern
major triad inversions across and along DBG, and string shift root pos
diatonic barre chords and triads - spell chord along 1 string
find relative minor: play along 1 string and in pos or 3nps
play minor pentatonic each pattern

Play Song, ask: what is the Key, what is the tempo, meter, chord progression, are the chords diatonic? What is the arrangement? What is your favorite part of the song, what imagery does it solicit? If this song were in a movie trailer or movie scene what would the scene be?
Transpose progression to new key, apply open, barre or diad, embellished 7th chord voicing - improvise melody

Level 4

find notes up 12 down 5, and octave shapes (asc/dsc)
major scale along 1 string, in-position or 3nps pedal tone and 3rds, string shift 1 octave pedal tone
major pent 2 octaves and each position, all modes
major triad inversions across and along DBG and/or GBE
diatonic 7th chords
major 7 arpeggio inversions
find relative minor: play along 1 string and in pos or 3nps
play minor pentatonic all patterns across, along
and minor 7 arpeggio inversions
play diatonic minor key barre and triads

Play Song, ask: what is the Key, what is the tempo, meter, chord progression, are the chords diatonic? What is the arrangement? What is your favorite part of the song, what imagery does it solicit? If this song were in a movie trailer or movie scene what would the scene be? Transpose progression to new key, apply desired chord voicing, improvise melody and solo

Level 5

find notes up 12 down 5, and octave shapes
major scale along 1 string, in-position or 3nps pedal tone and 3rds, string shift 1 octave pedal tone
major pent 2 octaves and each position, all modes
major triad inversions across and along any string set
diatonic 7th chords, all diatonic arpeggio inversions
find relative minor: play along 1 string and in pos or 3nps
play minor pentatonic all patterns, across/along/diagonal
diatonic 7th chords

Play Song, ask: what is the Key, what is the tempo, meter, chord progression, are the chords diatonic? What is the arrangement? What is your favorite part of the song, what imagery does it solicit? If this song were in a movie trailer or movie scene what would the scene be? Transpose progression to new key, apply desired chord voicing, improvise melody and solo

****Student and instructor opt-in to additional review material that is in line with students goal statement***

Start with Song - Option 2

Play Song, ask: what is the Key, what is the tempo, meter, chord progression, are the chords diatonic? What is the arrangement? What is your favorite part of the song, what imagery does it solicit? If this song were in a movie trailer or movie scene what would the scene be?

Ask yourself “what review would i do based on my level, to prepare to perform or improvise over this song?”

Ex. Eyes Without a Face - Emaj7 C#min G#min B or Imaj7 vimin iimin V
Level 2 in E, reverse order or from find the E note?

Transpose progression to new key, apply desired chord voicing, improvise melody and solo

Long term crafting of your musical voice

Choose from Guitarmalade Bag O'Tricks and observe/catalogue BOTH rhythm and lead concepts, licks and approaches for your OWN Bag O'Tricks

For example:

Rhythm - EJ spread voicings, triads with non chord tones, double stops, neo soul hammer-on/pull-offs, diads (10ths), slapping a la mayer/fujita

Lead: 2nps sliding arpeggios, sweep arpeggios w non chord tones, cascading pentatonic licks, diminished over dom 7 vs altered over dom 7, abac melodic motif, rhythm displacement

TEST choose chord progression, chord voicing type and rhythm, loop progression

improvise using 3-5 lead guitar concepts and record a live solo, or compose and step record your ultimate solo - reflect on what you like and what can be better, determine what you learned in the process of composing solo